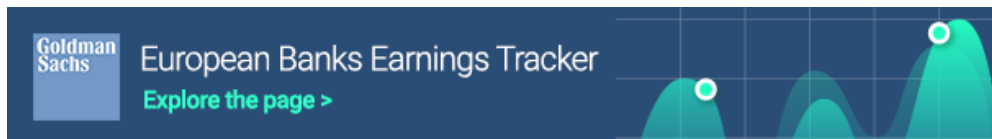


STANDARD CHARTERED (STAN.L/2888.HK)

Updating for 4Q25 results



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In short: Q4 miss, with 2026 guidance above consensus. NII 8% ahead in the quarter of which c.5% is driven by a temporary tailwind from elevated HIBOR (which has since reversed); non-NII was 11% below but included a \$170mn headwind y/y from significantly lower episodic items in Global Markets (market moves and timing effects). Underlying operating income is therefore 1% light vs company-compiled consensus. Underlying operating expenses were 4% higher than expected of which c.85% comes from three items called out (India Pension changes, share vesting changes and cash-settled stock awards). Credit impairments were better than expected due to recoveries in the CIB, while one-offs were \$164mn higher than expected (litigation, other restructuring and property gains); this leaves reported PBT 23% below consensus, reported net profit 29% below and reported ROTE at 4.8% vs consensus at 6.1%. Capital distribution is better than expected with DPS 30% above consensus and a new share buyback of \$1.5bn announced (cons. \$1.4bn). Looking ahead, 2026 guidance on revenue (better on NII and non-NII) and costs (slightly above cons.) implies PPP is c.-3-5% ahead of consensus, on our estimates. While headline reported ROTE guidance for 2026E of >12% compares to consensus at 11.7%.

Net interest income: NII -1% y/y but +8% q/q at \$2,949mn at Q4, beating company-compiled consensus by 8%/\$207mn, with an 86bp increase in HIBOR driving a temporary improvement in CASA pass-through during Q4 (+1.5% q/q excluding tailwind of rates and margin, while STAN notes that the HIBOR impact has since reversed in 1Q'26), alongside timing benefit in treasury income. For FY25, NII was +1% y/y (on constant currency), as headwinds from lower policy rates and WRB portfolio actions were offset by improvement in both mix and volumes. Underlying deposits +12% y/y, driven by i) WRB following NNM campaigns, alongside growth in CASA and term deposits, and ii) CIB via Transaction Services CASA and term deposits. Underlying loans and advances +5% y/y, driven in particular by i) WRB increase given momentum in lending and mortgages, although offset in part by a reduction in unsecured, and ii) CIB loan growth primarily within Global Banking. STAN

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guide for NII to be broadly flat y/y in 2026, based on the assumptions that i) currency-weighted average rates are expected to drop by 44bp in 2026 (although this reflects a less pronounced drop than the 55bp change which was expected at Q3'25 results), ii) pass-through rates expected to return within guidance range (60-75% in CIB, 35-50% in WRB), ii) continued WRB portfolio actions (-2% NII headwind expected), and iv) albeit offset by continued growth in volumes. Net net, our NII forecasts rise by 1% in 2026E while falling 3% in 2027/28E.

Operating income and Non-NII: Underlying non-NII was \$1,899mn at Q4, +2% y/y but 11%/\$244mn below consensus expectations, including non-NII headwinds from episodic income within Global Markets (-\$16mn at Q4'25, down from \$154mn at Q4'24 and \$120mn at Q3'25) due to the timing of large client deals and various market movements which affected inventory held for client activity (driving a Global Markets revenue miss of 17% vs consensus). Furthermore, Transaction Services business posted income down 9% y/y (albeit beating consensus estimates by 2%), given a reduction in Payments & Liquidity given rates impact. Altogether, underlying operating income (\$4,848mn) missed consensus by 1%/\$37mn, as a \$207mn better-than-expected performance in NII (driven by rates and margin, including a temporary HIBOR improvement), was more than offset by the \$244mn miss in non-NII. Q4 included a \$9mn gain from notable items (revaluation of FX positions in Egypt, and hyperinflation accounting adjustment in Ghana), while we note that Q3 included a \$10mn loss from the same items (net net, resulting in a modest \$1mn loss for FY25). Looking ahead, STAN guide for operating income growth y/y at the bottom-end of a 5-7% range in 2026, assuming constant currency. Overall, our total operating income forecasts rise 0-1% over 2026-28E.

Operating expenses: Excluding the UK bank levy of \$52mn at Q4 (which was c.\$50mn below both consensus and the Q4'24 equivalent levy), operating expenses rose +5% y/y to \$3,429mn for the quarter (4%/\$143mn higher than consensus), driven by an uptick (+\$121mn q/q) in share price & regulatory changes, which included i) regulatory changes on India pensions, ii) a PRA rule change on the accelerated vesting of shares, and iii) increase in share price impact during Q4 on cash-settled deferred stock awards. The largest driver q/q of operating expenses was business growth & inflation (+\$307mn), which included hiring of RMs within the WRB segment, and coverage bankers in the CIB, as well as an uptick in performance-related compensation (driven in part by share price increases and regulatory changes which led to the acceleration of deferred bonuses). However, these cost increases were offset in part by efficiency savings (largely from the Fit for Growth programme). The CIR for Q4'25 was 71% (up from 68% at Q4'24), with the overall FY25 CIR at 59% (an improvement from 60% at FY24). For 2026, STAN guides for reported costs to be broadly flat, assuming constant currency and including FFG charges (c.\$0.6bn) and other restructuring charges (c.\$0.2bn), thus implying c.\$13.3bn in total. Our total expense forecasts increase 1-2% over 2026-28E, driven by modestly higher assumed underlying costs, in addition to higher expected restructuring charges.

Credit impairments were \$145mn, 36% below consensus. With \$46mn in recoveries in CIB and with WRB slightly lower y/y (at \$156mn). Loan loss rates were 14bps in Q4 and 19bps for FY25 as a whole. These are still expected to normalise towards the historical through-the-cycle guidance range of 30-35bps. Our credit impairment forecasts trend higher through the forecast period (2026 31bps, 2027 33bps) reflecting this expected normalisation.

Capital: CET1% was in line with expectations for Q4 at 14.1% with CET1 capital and RWAs both c.1% lower than expected. RWAs decreased by \$0.4bn q/q mainly driven by a \$4.1bn reduction in Market Risk RWAs partly offset by \$2.6bn in OpRisk add-ons (now recognised in Q4 vs Q1 in prior years), +\$0.9bn in Credit Risk, and +\$0.2bn from FX. CET1% was 4bps lower q/q, with the AT1 coupon and dividend accrual offsetting the tailwind from net profit. In terms of distribution, Standard Chartered has announced a new share buyback program of \$1.5bn which would take the pro-forma CET1% to 13.5%. DPS for FY25 stands at 60.9 cents, 30% higher than consensus at 47 cents (with the final DPS of 48.6cents above consensus expectation for 34.7 cents).

Profitability: Underlying net profit (post minorities and AT1) was \$845mn in Q4, 5% above consensus with the 6% underlying PBT miss partly offset by lower tax expenses and minorities. Underlying ROTE was 9.6% in Q4, 110bps above consensus (8.5%). On a reported basis net profit was 29% below consensus and reported ROTE was 4.8% in Q4 vs consensus 6.1% and for FY25 as a whole it was 11.9% vs consensus at 12.4%. The Group guides for reported ROTE in 2026 of >12% (consensus 11.7%). We model 12.5% reported ROTE in 2026E, increasing to 14.6% in 2027E (supported by underlying operating leverage and a reduction in restructuring charges relating to Fit for Growth).

2026 guidance points:

- Reported operating income growth year-on-year to be around the bottom end of 5–7% range (at ccy). Implies c.\$21.9bn (at +5% y/y), 2% above consensus (\$21.5bn).
- Underlying NII expected to be broadly flat y/y (at ccy). Implies c.\$11.2bn, 2% above consensus (\$11bn).
 - 44bps weighted average interest rates headwind y/y in 2026 (implies \$273mn in NII headwind y/y using the updated IRRBB sensitivity of \$620mn per 100bps parallel shift).
 - Pass-through rates expected to move back within the guidance range (60–75% in CIB, 35–50% in WRB).
 - Ongoing WRB portfolio actions expected to be a c.2% headwind to NII y/y.
- Reported costs to be broadly flat (at ccy), including FFG charges (c.\$0.6bn) and other restructuring (c.\$0.2bn). Implies \$13.28bn, \$54mn (0.4%) above consensus (\$13.22bn).
- Underlying costs expected to be c.\$12.6bn, 2% above consensus (\$12.38bn) with c.\$0.7bn in business growth & inflation headwinds y/y offset by c.\$0.4bn in FFG savings.
- Statutory ROTE >12%. Consensus 11.7%. 12% would imply c.\$4.7bn in net profit (reported), c.1% above consensus (\$4.6bn).

Additional guidance points:

- Fit For Growth (FFG) is now expected to total c.\$1.3bn in both cost-to-achieve (CTA) and savings vs. \$1.5bn previously. 2026 will still market the final year of CTA (at c.\$0.6mn) with c.\$0.4bn in-year savings in 2026 and c.\$0.3bn in 2027.
- The hedge will increase in size in 2026 but not necessarily by the same degree as in 2025.

- 2027+ costs to be driven by a) no further FFG CTA, b) business growth & inflation, and c) further efficiency sales from FFG and other initiatives.
- Loan-loss rates are expected to normalise towards the historical through-the-cycle guidance range of 30-35bps.
- Q1'26 has started strongly across CIB and WRB.

Estimate changes, valuation and key risks

Our headline net profit forecasts remain largely unchanged in 2026E, while decreasing 2%/1% in 2027/28E given modestly higher assumed opex (including run-rate restructuring charges). Our underlying EPS forecasts, however, increase 1-2% over 2026-28E driven by 1) a lower assumed sharecount (with the new \$1.5bn share buyback announced above GSe at \$1.4bn, also supported by a mark to market for the latest share price), and 2) modestly higher assumed revenues (primarily in the CIB, which more than offset the increase in underlying opex, exc. restructuring).

Our 12m price target for STAN.L increases 5% to 2,135p (2,025p previously) as we roll forward our P/E valuation methodology to apply entirely to 2027E earnings (25%/75% previously on 2026/27E) using an unchanged 10.25x multiple, combined with the recent supportive move in GBP/USD FX, and slightly higher underlying EPS forecasts.

Our 12m price target for 2888.HK (based on a 2-stage dividend discount model) increases 2% to HK\$233 (HK\$228 previously) on our revised estimates.

We are Buy-rated on STAN.L and 2888.HK. Key downside risks include reversal/pause of positive jaws delivery, slower-than-expected non-interest income growth, lower-than-expected net interest income growth.

Exhibit 1: 4Q25 earnings review

\$mn, unless stated otherwise

\$mn, unless otherwise stated	Actual					4Q25E		Overview			
	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	GS	Cons	q/q	y/y	act/GS	Act/cons
Net interest income	2,977	2,796	2,703	2,737	2,949	2,761	2,742	8%	(1%)	7%	8%
Other income	1,857	2,594	2,806	2,410	1,899	2,194	2,143	(21%)	2%	(13%)	(11%)
- of which: notable items	25	-	-	(10)	9	-	-				
Operating income	4,834	5,390	5,509	5,147	4,848	4,955	4,885	(6%)	0%	(2%)	(1%)
Operating income ex notable items	4,809	5,390	5,509	5,157	4,839	4,955	4,885	(6%)	1%	(2%)	(1%)
Other operating expenses	(3,277)	(2,915)	(3,050)	(2,953)	(3,429)	(3,397)	(3,286)	16%	5%	1%	4%
UK bank levy	(102)	-	-	-	(52)	(102)	(102)	-	(49%)	(49%)	(49%)
Operating costs	(3,379)	(2,915)	(3,050)	(2,953)	(3,481)	(3,499)	(3,388)	18%	3%	(1%)	3%
PPOP	1,455	2,475	2,459	2,194	1,367	1,455	1,497	(38%)	(6%)	(6%)	(9%)
PPOP ex notable items	1,430	2,475	2,459	2,204	1,358	1,455	1,497	(38%)	(5%)	(7%)	(9%)
Loan impairments	(130)	(219)	(117)	(195)	(145)	(206)	(228)	(26%)	12%	(29%)	(36%)
Other impairments	(353)	(6)	(3)	(20)	(13)	(36)	(47)	(35%)	(96%)	(64%)	(72%)
Associates	(27)	27	64	6	(26)	(27)	(9)	(533%)	(4%)	(4%)	189%
PBT - Underlying	945	2,277	2,403	1,985	1,183	1,186	1,213	(40%)	25%	(0%)	(2%)
PBT ex notable items - Underlying	920	2,277	2,403	1,995	1,174	1,186	1,213	(41%)	28%	(1%)	(3%)
PBT - Statutory	800	2,103	2,280	1,766	814	988	1,056	(54%)	2%	(18%)	(23%)
Tax/minority	(307)	(746)	(572)	(738)	(349)	(363)	(404)	(53%)	14%	(4%)	(14%)
Attributable profit	493	1,357	1,708	1,028	465	625	652	(55%)	(6%)	(26%)	(29%)
Balance Sheet (\$bn) and ratios											
Net Loans	281	282	287	285	287	286	288	1%	2%	0%	(0%)
CET1 Ratio	14.2%	13.8%	14.3%	14.2%	14.1%	14.2%	14.1%	-4bp	-12bp	-4bp	2bp
Risk-Weighted Assets	247	254	260	258	258	261	261	(0%)	4%	(1%)	(1%)

UK bank levy consensus input is from Visible Alpha Consensus Data, rest is company-compiled

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Company-compiled consensus, Visible Alpha Consensus Data

Exhibit 2: Revenues by product line over time

\$mn, unless stated otherwise

Underlying Revenue (\$mn unless otherwise stated)						4Q25E		Overview		
	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	GS	Cons	q/q	y/y	act/cons
Revenues by Product										
Transaction Services	1,666	1,527	1,469	1,488	1,521	1,465	1,485	2%	(9%)	2%
<i>Payments and Liquidity</i>	1,193	1,061	1,013	1,016	1,065	986	1,017	5%	(11%)	5%
<i>Securities Services</i>	161	151	158	166	173	164	164	4%	7%	5%
<i>Trade & Working Capital</i>	312	315	298	306	283	315	304	(8%)	(9%)	(7%)
Global Banking	500	548	548	588	545	512	549	(7%)	9%	(1%)
<i>Lending & Financial Solutions</i>	434	452	476	496	481	447	474	(3%)	11%	1%
<i>Capital Market & Advisory</i>	66	96	72	92	64	65	75	(30%)	(3%)	(15%)
Global Markets	773	1,183	1,172	848	660	767	791	(22%)	(15%)	(17%)
<i>Macro Trading</i>	654	978	961	678	499	654	642	(26%)	(24%)	(22%)
<i>Credit Trading</i>	138	222	187	206	138	142	157	(33%)	0%	(12%)
<i>Valuation & Other Adj</i>	(19)	(17)	24	(36)	23	(29)	(5)	(164%)	(221%)	(560%)
Wealth Solutions	562	777	742	890	677	697	689	(24%)	20%	(2%)
<i>Investment Products</i>	452	559	544	691	553	565	553	(20%)	22%	0%
<i>Bancassurance</i>	110	218	198	199	124	132	122	(38%)	13%	2%
Deposits & Mortgages	1,058	1,006	990	1,034	1,050	-	1,041	2%	(1%)	1%
CCPL & Other Unsecured Lending	270	257	282	277	264	-	271	(5%)	(2%)	(3%)
Ventures	60	42	278	39	56	44	54	44%	(7%)	4%
<i>Digital Banks</i>	41	42	46	49	58	52	51	18%	41%	14%
<i>SCV</i>	19	0	232	(10)	(2)	(8)	4	(80%)	(111%)	(150%)
Treasury & other	(55)	50	28	(7)	66	-	5	(1043%)	(220%)	1220%
Underlying Operating Income	4,834	5,390	5,509	5,157	4,839	4,955	4,885	(6%)	0%	(1%)

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Company-compiled consensus

Exhibit 3: GSe vs. Consensus

				Consensus			GS vs consensus		
In US\$m	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E
NII	11,221	11,427	11,981	11,006	11,255	11,891	2%	2%	1%
Non int inc	10,684	11,782	12,659	10,477	11,314	12,025	2%	4%	5%
Revenue	21,905	23,209	24,640	21,483	22,569	23,916	2%	3%	3%
Opex total	-12,578	-13,016	-13,537	-12,381	-12,738	-13,259	2%	2%	2%
PPOP	9,327	10,193	11,103	9,102	9,831	10,657	2%	4%	4%
Loan imp.	-890	-988	-1,137	-993	-1,077	-1,164	-10%	-8%	-2%
Other imp.	-124	-124	-124	-77	-74	-80	61%	68%	55%
Associates	48	49	50	92	102	120	-48%	-52%	-59%
PBT - underlying	8,360	9,129	9,891	8,124	8,782	9,534	3%	4%	4%
PBT - reported	7,595	8,929	9,691	7,277	8,568	9,418	4%	4%	3%
Core EPS (US\$ cents)	252.7	290.5	335.2	239.9	277.5	--	5%	5%	--
DPS (US\$ cents)	70.7	83.7	112.4	55.3	67.4	--	28%	24%	--
Statutory ROTE	12.5%	14.6%	15.4%	11.7%	13.8%	--	0.8%	0.8%	--
Underlying ROTE	14.2%	15.1%	15.8%	13.3%	14.2%	15.0%	0.9%	0.9%	0.7%

Company-compiled consensus for 2026/27, Visible Alpha Consensus Data for 2028

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 4: GS estimates old vs. new

\$ bn	Old			New			Change, %		
	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E
STAN									
Revenue	21.8	23.1	24.5	21.9	23.2	24.6	1%	0%	1%
Opex	(13.2)	(12.9)	(13.4)	(13.3)	(13.2)	(13.7)	1%	2%	2%
LLP	(0.9)	(1.0)	(1.1)	(0.9)	(1.0)	(1.1)	5%	3%	3%
PBT	7.6	9.1	9.8	7.6	8.9	9.7	(0%)	(2%)	(1%)
Net income	4.858	5.957	6.448	4.878	5.825	6.366	0%	(2%)	(1%)
GS EPS	2.42	2.78	3.17	2.46	2.81	3.24	1%	1%	2%
CET1 ratio, %	14.1%	14.2%	14.1%	13.9%	14.0%	13.9%	-18 bps	-22 bps	-25 bps

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

STAN.L		12m Price Target: 2135p		Price: 1802p		Upside: 18.5%	
Buy		GS Forecast					
			12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E	
Market cap: £40.5bn / \$54.7bn		Net inc. (\$ mn) New	4,558.0	4,877.7	5,824.9	6,365.6	
3m ADTV :£81.8mn/ \$110.0mn		Net inc. (\$ mn) Old	4,718.3	4,858.4	5,956.7	6,447.7	
United Kingdom		EPS (\$) New	2.23	2.46	2.81	3.24	
Europe Banks		EPS (\$) Old	2.25	2.42	2.78	3.17	
		EPS growth (%)	40.5	10.3	14.6	15.1	
M&A Rank: 3		P/E (X)	7.7	9.9	8.6	7.5	
		P/B (X)	0.9	1.1	1.0	0.9	
		Price/PPOP (X)	7.2	6.4	5.5	5.0	
		Dividend yield (%)	3.5	2.9	3.4	4.6	
			12/25	3/26E	6/26E	9/26E	
		EPS (\$)	0.36	0.64	0.74	0.60	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 20 Feb 2026 close.

2888.HK	12m Price Target: HK\$233	Price: HK\$192	Upside: 21.4%		
Buy	GS Forecast				
		12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Market cap: HK\$431.4bn / \$55.2bn	Net inc. (\$ mn) New	4,558.0	4,877.7	5,824.9	6,365.6
3m ADTV :HK\$172.0mn/ \$22.1mn	Net inc. (\$ mn) Old	4,718.3	4,858.4	5,956.7	6,447.7
Hong Kong	EPS (HK\$) New	17.32	19.10	21.90	25.20
Asia Financials	EPS (HK\$) Old	17.50	18.86	21.62	24.65
	EPS growth (%)	40.7	10.2	14.5	15.1
M&A Rank: 3	P/E (X)	7.7	10.0	8.8	7.6
	P/B (X)	0.9	1.1	1.1	1.0
	Price/PPOP (X)	7.2	6.4	5.5	5.1
	Dividend yield (%)	3.5	2.9	3.4	4.6
		12/25	3/26E	6/26E	9/26E
	EPS (HK\$)	2.77	4.99	5.76	4.63

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 23 Feb 2026 close.

Standard Chartered is a global bank with over 650 branches in 53 markets. STAN HK is the 3rd largest player, holding ~12%/11% of HK local market shares in deposits/loans. We are Buy rated on STAN.L/2888.HK given **(1) Robust and sustained momentum in the affluent segment.** We see the bank as well-positioned to leverage the robust and sustained liquidity inflows into Hong Kong and Singapore, a significant tailwind that we believe will continue to fuel its growth and differentiate its performance from peers. **(2) Positive trajectory in Global Markets and Banking,** underpinned by steady market share gains. **(3) Positive jaws with scope to further unlock operational leverage.** **(4) Attractive shareholder returns** with total yield (dividend + buybacks) ranking among the top quartile of DM comps. We expect statutory ROTE to trend above 12% for 2026E (target >12%), and to improve notably further in 2027-2028E. Key downside risks include reversal/pause of positive jaws delivery, slower-than-expected non-interest income growth, lower-than-expected net interest income growth.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

We, Chris Hallam, Melissa Kuang, CFA, Benjamin Caven-Roberts, Sachin Nayar, Wing Huang and Wayne Wang, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect our personal views about the subject company or companies and its or their securities. We also certify that no part of our compensation was, is or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views expressed in this report.

Unless otherwise stated, the individuals listed on the cover page of this report are analysts in Goldman Sachs' Global Investment Research division.

GS Factor Profile

The Goldman Sachs Factor Profile provides investment context for a stock by comparing key attributes to the market (i.e. our universe of rated stocks) and its sector peers. The four key attributes depicted are: Growth, Financial Returns, Multiple (e.g. valuation) and Integrated (a composite of Growth, Financial Returns and Multiple). Growth, Financial Returns and Multiple are calculated by using normalized ranks for specific metrics for each stock. The normalized ranks for the metrics are then averaged and converted into percentiles for the relevant attribute. The precise calculation of each metric may vary depending on the fiscal year, industry and region, but the standard approach is as follows:

Growth is based on a stock's forward-looking sales growth, EBITDA growth and EPS growth (for financial stocks, only EPS and sales growth), with a higher percentile indicating a higher growth company. **Financial Returns** is based on a stock's forward-looking ROE, ROCE and CROCI (for financial stocks, only ROE), with a higher percentile indicating a company with higher financial returns. **Multiple** is based on a stock's forward-looking P/E, P/B, price/dividend (P/D), EV/EBITDA, EV/FCF and EV/Debt Adjusted Cash Flow (DACF) (for financial stocks, only P/E, P/B and P/D), with a higher percentile indicating a stock trading at a higher multiple. The **Integrated** percentile is calculated as the average of the Growth percentile, Financial Returns percentile and (100% - Multiple percentile).

Financial Returns and Multiple use the Goldman Sachs analyst forecasts at the fiscal year-end at least three quarters in the future. Growth uses inputs for the fiscal year at least seven quarters in the future compared with the year at least three quarters in the future (on a per-share basis for all metrics).

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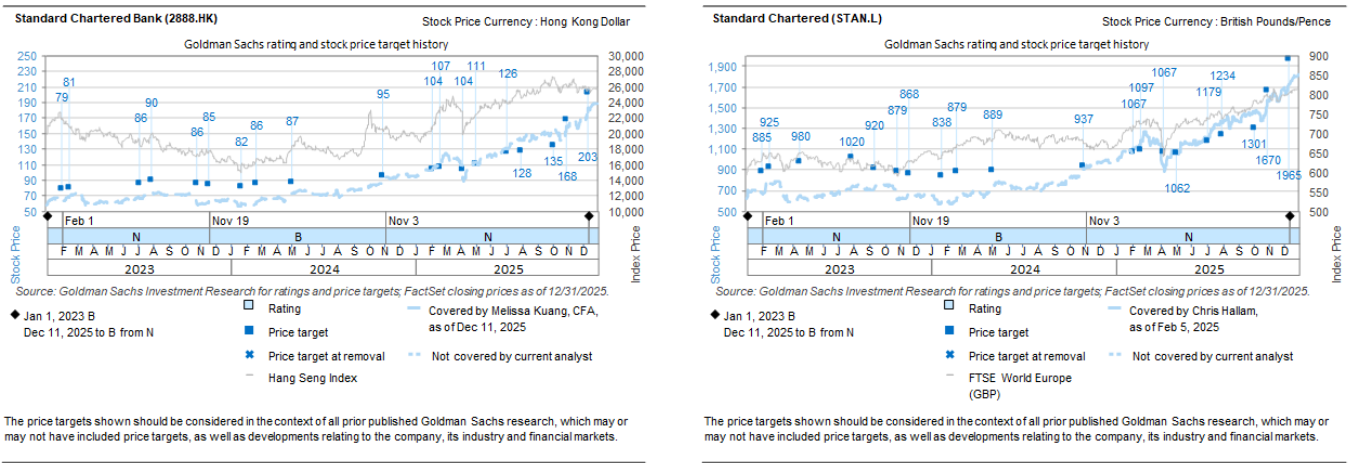
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Price target and rating history chart(s)



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